

the last working snapshot of your project; for example, if you accidentally introduce a bug while working on a new feature. Each snapshot is called a *commit*.

Using Git, you can try implementing new features without worrying about breaking your project. When you're deploying to a live server, you need to make sure you're deploying a working version of your project. To read more about Git and version control, see Appendix D.

Installing Git

Git may already be installed on your system. To find out, open a new terminal window and issue the command `git --version`:

```
(ll_env)learning_log$ git --version
git version 2.30.1 (Apple Git-130)
```

If you get a message indicating that Git is not installed, see the installation instructions in Appendix D.

Configuring Git

Git keeps track of who makes changes to a project, even when only one person is working on the project. To do this, Git needs to know your username and email. You must provide a username, but you can make up an email for your practice projects:

```
(ll_env)learning_log$ git config --global user.name "eric"
(ll_env)learning_log$ git config --global user.email "eric@example.com"
```

If you forget this step, Git will prompt you for this information when you make your first commit.

Ignoring Files

We don't need Git to track every file in the project, so we'll tell it to ignore some files. Create a file called *.gitignore* in the folder that contains *manage.py*. Notice that this filename begins with a dot and has no file extension. Here's the code that goes in *.gitignore*:

```
.gitignore ll_env/
__pycache__/
*.sqlite3
```

We tell Git to ignore the entire *ll_env* directory, because we can re-create it automatically at any time. We also don't track the *__pycache__* directory, which contains the *.pyc* files that are created automatically when the *.py* files are executed. We don't track changes to the local database, because it's a bad habit: if you're ever using SQLite on a server, you might accidentally overwrite the live database with your local test database when you push the project to the server. The asterisk in **.sqlite3* tells Git to ignore any file that ends with the extension *.sqlite3*.